

Tao Xu

The University of Edinburgh, College of Arts, Humanities and Social Sciences, Graduate School of Social and Political Science, Chrystal Macmillan Building, 15a George Square, Edinburgh EH8 9LD, Scotland

W: taocxu.github.io L: www.linkedin.com/in/tao-c-xu T: +86 189 1266 0778 E: taocxu@foxmail.com

A driven and motivated individual, graduating with the highest distinction from NUFE, currently studying towards an M.Sc. Development Studies at the University of Edinburgh, and actively pursuing a Ph.D. afterwards, with extensive experience gained from completing internships at the Administration for Market Regulation, Bureau of Finance, CITIC, Mazars, Deloitte, RF Development, DKU, and additionally obtained professional memberships at the Association for Social Economics, and Chinese Society for Technology Economics. Possessing exceptional analytical skills, a keen eye for detail, and a proven track record of thriving in pressurised and challenging environments. A target-driven communicator, with the ability to build and maintain strong working relationships and lead teams as required. Diligent and adaptable, committed to continuous personal development, and seeking a new professional challenge to apply my academic knowledge and a highly transferable skill set, from scientific models to the real world, and from praxes back to theories.

SKILLS & RESEARCH INTERESTS

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|------------------------------|----------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| ▪ Target Driven | ▪ New Structural Economics | ▪ Inequality & Poverty |
| ▪ Complex Problem Solving | ▪ Agglomeration and Spillover | ▪ Epidemiology and Global Health |
| ▪ Sociocultural Anthropology | ▪ Advanced Manufacturing Cluster | ▪ Research & Report Writing |
| ▪ International Economics | ▪ Labour & Employment | ▪ Design and Systems Thinking |
| ▪ Development Studies | ▪ Industrial Policy and Strategy | ▪ IT Literate |

QUALIFICATIONS, AWARDS & PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

M.Sc. Development Studies (International Development, Expected Merit) - The University of Edinburgh, *Aug 2024*

Dissertation Topic: (Initially Proposed) Closer to Industry 4.0? Political Settlements and Industrial Linkages: China and Indonesia 1990–2018

Supervisor: Hazel Gray, PhD, Senior Lecturer in African Studies & International Development

Key Modules: Anthropology of International Development; Politics and Theories of International Development; Research Design & Practice; Resource Politics and Development; Interpreting Development Institutions & Practices; Governance, Development and Poverty in Africa; Key Skills in Development Practice

B.Sc. Economics (Commercial Economics, 1st: 91.29/100) - Nanjing University of Finance and Economics, *Jun 2023*

Dissertation Topic: Towards Sustainable Prosperity? Policy Evaluation of Jiangsu Advanced Manufacturing Clusters

Supervisor: Yabei Hu, PhD, Professor of Industrial Economics

Key Modules: Microeconomics; Macroeconomics; Econometrics; Industrial Economics; International Economics; Regional & Urban Economics; Regional Market and Interregional Trade; Platform Economics; Business Economics; Economics of Business Enterprise; Economic History; Business Design & Innovation; Retailing and Wholesaling Studies; Marketing; Procurement & Supply Chain Management

Summer/Winter Schools, Workshops & Seminars

Research Methodology in Applied Economics, Adv/Grad - Nanjing Agricultural University, Prof Zhigang Xu, *Aug 2023*

Big Data Analytics in Geospatial Sciences, Adv/Grad - Nanjing Normal University, Prof Xueying Zhang, *Aug 2023*

Political Economy & Economics, Advanced/Grad - Wuhan University, Prof Shaodong Zhou, *Jul 2023*

International Business Management - University of California Los Angeles & University of Saint Joseph (Catholic University of Macao), Prof David E. French, *Feb 2022*

Training, Courses & Certifications

IELTS Academic C1, College English Test Band 6, National Computer Rank Examination Level 2

Excel & Access & Word & PowerPoint & Publisher & Canva (IT Literate, Communication & Social Media)

STATA & EViews & Python & Matlab & GeoScene & ArcGIS (Statistics, Quantitative Economics & Econometrics)
 NVivo & VOSviewer & CiteSpace (Text Analytics & Bibliometrics)
 Health Systems Development, Epidemiology for Public Health - Imperial College London
 Epidemiology: The Basic Science of Public Health - The University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill
 Microeconomics, The Economics of Health Care Delivery, Comparative Health Systems - University of Pennsylvania
 The Korean Economic Development - Yonsei University
 Local Economic Development - Erasmus University Rotterdam
 Understanding Research Methods - SOAS University of London
 Game Theory & Advanced Applications - Stanford University & The University of British Columbia
 New Structural Economics, Behavioral Economics, Introduction to Logic - Peking University
 Corporate Finance, Advanced Quantitative Methods for Social Research - Central University of Finance and Economics

Honours & Awards

Jiangsu Provincial Government Scholarship for Overseas Studies	NUFE Principal's Scholarship
Jiangsu Provincial Distinguished Dissertation Award 1st Class	NUFE Honours Graduate
NUFE Distinguished Dissertation Award	NUFE Honours Student *3
NUFE Merit Scholarship for Academic Excellence *6	NUFE Outstanding Student Leader Award
NUFE Merit Scholarship for High Calibre *3	NNU Outstanding Student Award
WHU Outstanding Student Award	WHU Distinguished Paper Award

Professional Memberships

Association for Social Economics (ASE1496) Chinese Society for Technology Economics (I031402003A)
 Chinese Society for Environmental Sciences (S290086411A)
 Chinese Society for Optimisation, Overall Planning & Economic Mathematics (S320004285A)

PUBLICATIONS

- "Towards Sustainable Prosperity? Policy Evaluation of Jiangsu Advanced Manufacturing Clusters," with Yabei Hu, *Technology in Society*, 2024, 102583.
- "Common Prosperity and the Middle Class," *WHU Proceedings of the Summer Institute on Marxian Economics*, 2023, 4, 1–5.
- "Mismatch and Dysfunction: Internet-Based Optimised Path of Elderly Consumer Market," with Yukun Gu, Yibo Wang, Yansong Wang, and Qifei Chen, *Journal of the Jiangsu Association for Commercial Economics*, 2021, 38, 3–9.
- "Silver-Hair Industry Reshaped with New Retailing: A SWOT-Based Strategy," *Journal of the China Federation of Logistics*, 2021, 28, 82–85.

WORKING PAPERS

- "The e-CNY as a Cure for SME Financing Obstacles? Based on Modelling and Simulation of Evolutionary Game Dynamics," with Cheng Yuan, and Yansong Wang, 2022, ChinaXiv 202207.00004, National Science Library, Chinese Academy of Sciences; R&R.
- "Entrepreneurs or Employees: What Chinese Citizens Encouraged to Become by Social Attitudes?" 2022, MPRA 113212, University Library of Munich.
- "Rural Pension System Reform and Social Insurance Participation: 20 Years of Peasant Life in Changing China," with Yansong Wang, and Zhengyi Hu, advised by Dr Yongliang Wu, 2021, arXiv 2204.00785, Cornell Tech.
- "Eudemonia and Freedom: Frontiers and Evolution of Labour and Employment Studies in China," with Weiwei Zhu, advised by Ruru Li and Prof Wenwu Zhang, 2021, MPRA 112908.

WORK IN PROGRESS

- "Closer to Industry 4.0? Political Settlements and Industrial Linkages: China and Indonesia 1990–2018," at the University of Edinburgh.
- "Dependency on the State or Balance of Three Pillars? Pension System and Multidimensional Poverty Reduction in

China," with Yansong Wang, Yongfan Li, and Cheng Yuan.

- "Participation in Three-Pillar Pension System and Household Vulnerability to Multidimensional Poverty: Evidence from China," with Yansong Wang, and Cheng Yuan.
- "Relying Beyond Government: Multilayered Pension System as a Catalyst for Household Development Resilience," with Yansong Wang.

REPORTS, PRESENTATIONS & BOOK REVIEWS

- "Social Embeddedness of Bolivia's Water Wars: Revisit to Polanyi Critique," 2024, Edinburgh.
- "Celebrities as Intermediaries: The Dynamics of Development Communication," 2024, Edinburgh.
- "Good Governance and Political Settlements in Africa," 2024, Edinburgh.
- "Turbulence and Order in Economic Development: Economic Transformation in Tanzania and Vietnam by Hazel Gray," 2024, Edinburgh.
- "To Rebel, or Not to Rebel? People First Anthropology in Development Praxis," 2024, Edinburgh.
- "Just Transition? Free, Prior, and Informed Consent in Resource-Driven Development," 2023, Edinburgh.
- "Belt of Productivity, Road to Equality: China's Infrastructure Initiative as the 'People First' Development in Indonesia," 2023, Edinburgh.
- "Having People, Having Heart: Charity, Sustainable Development, and Problems of Dependence in Central Uganda by China Scherz," 2023, Edinburgh.
- "Development of Jiangsu Wholesale Market in the Context of Internet: Types, Structures, and Strategies," with Y Gu, and Y Wang, advised by Prof Chunfa Zhang, 2022, Nanjing.
- "The Theory of Economic Development by Joseph Schumpeter," 2022, Nanjing.
- "Survey on Local Pharmaceutical Specialty Stores: Retail Formats, Elements, and Practice," with Y Gu, Y Wang, Dapeng Zhu, Wei Li, Zhenyu Zhang, Jingxia Hou, and Yuhan Yang, advised by Prof Jinguo Tao, 2021, Nanjing.
- "The Social Contract by Jean-Jacques Rousseau," 2021, Nanjing.
- "Cultural Industry and Poverty Mitigation: How Industrial Organisations in Less-Developed Areas Capitalise on Local Historical Heritage?" with W Zhu, 2021, Shuzhou.
- "A Study of History by Arnold Toynbee," 2021, Nanjing.
- "Survey on Guannan Rural Areas: Consumption, Social Security, and Manufacturing Industry for the Silver Economy," with Y Gu, and Y Wang, advised by Prof Qifei Chen, 2020, Guannan.
- "Focus on Silver-Hair Group: Ageing Society, Youth Responsibility, and Social Justice," with Y Wang, 2020, Guannan.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Coordinator Assistant (Internship) - Duke Kunshan (Kunshan, Suzhou)

2023

Student Affairs, Campus Engagement, Arts & Culture, Clubs & Organisations, FYE & SYE Transition

- Planned and managed training sessions, recruitment applications, policy revisions, registration surveys, offer-letter drafts, evaluation forms, poster-and-flyer designs, location check-outs, list compilations, and general operations of coordination and collaboration, to ensure the success of FYSAC, Orientation and Commencement
- Utilised effective communication skills to support for interviewing student workers, provided assistance and innovative advice in the development and organisation of student groups including FYSAC (14), OL (107), Commencement Volunteer (97), selected representatives such as FYSAC chairs and OL captains based on applications, resumes, and interview reports, and supported the success of student-leader teams
- Displayed a commitment to professional advancement, attended leadership presentations and interviews, and participated in Student Affairs Learning Series (Becoming Socialised in Student Affairs Administration, NASPA Competency, Vowels of Supervision, and Diversity, Equity & Inclusion), and CE & SA Meetings
- Created and edited content to support office initiatives, collected and evaluated event data on program for the spring semester, demonstrated exceptional creative writing and infographic design skills, to prepare slides and collateral materials for meetings and public account promotions
- Identified characteristics of successful and unsuccessful events, proposed improvements to evaluation systems, and improved the logic of post-event survey based on marketing knowledge

- Distributed packages for multiple events, including DKU Welcome Gifts to new-comer international students, and delivered souvenirs and prizes to winners or participants involved in campus programs such as Scavenger Hunt, MOMENT, and De-Stress Festival
- Studied exhibition legal documents, drafted licensing and copyright agreements and contracts for the use of photography works and portraits, to develop related systems and procedures
- Worked with Clubs & Orgs and FYE as a liaison, compiled info on club leaders for marketing, demonstrated excellent coordination skills, to support various events such as Involvement Expo, ACG Expo, Arts & Music Festival, Who's Still Standing, and Guest Speaker Lectures (Google China, UNHCR)
- Worked as the Commencement Committee Assistant, oversaw the content of the DKU Yearbook, improved the structure for 2023, translated and polished Chancellors' Remarks for the Commencement Brochure and UG Bulletin, collected Messages from Students, and made edits for inclusion
- Sorted multifarious lists for the DKU Commencement Registration and Photo Session, coordinated graduation-related tasks such as ceremony, banquet, and concert, and wrote different types of letters, intros, and surveys, to promote and announce on DKU Commencement website in English and Chinese
- Implemented a communication strategy to ensure consistency and coordination of messages across different channels to promote a positive image, assisted with social media, summarised policy-and-procedure docs for the establishment of WeChat official account, prepared necessary materials for operation and development, arranged columns and sub-columns, planned content, structure, and time stage of posting articles and tweets
- Executed administrative and logistical tasks including deposit reimbursement (expense reports), storage management, quarterly reflections, minutes of meetings, and email organisation

Executive Assistant (Internship) - RF Development (Border Economic Cooperation Zone, Ili) 2022
Real Estate, Construction, Regional Development, Operations Management

- Documented the politics, economy, culture, geography and religion of Ili Kazakh Autonomous Prefecture, studied and analysed the current status of regional revitalisation of Xinjiang Uyghur Autonomous Region
- Focused on real estate development and management, drafted investment and business projects targeting land planning policies and academic papers to promote regional economic growth in Yining Border Economic Cooperation Zone, through private sector's functions on construction, transportation and wholesale

Advisor Assistant (Internship) - Deloitte (Industrial Park, Suzhou) 2021
Tax & Business Advisory Services, Transfer Pricing, Operations Transformation

- Combined business overviews and executive summaries, prepared tables of investment, fixed assets, tax credits, inventory, contingencies and other key findings
- Collated Petroliam Nasional Bhd stage financial statements and organisation structures of PMCCL, PLSCL, PCMC
- Assisted in completion of translation and analysis of reports, translated 3 appendices of a transfer pricing draft and supported analysts to search potential comparable manufacturers and service providers with TP Catalyst
- Conducted business reviews with D&B Hoovers to obtain 18 and 78 comparable companies for business and TNMM analysis
- Supported the team in using RoyaltyStat database to retrieve 517 CAs, reviewed to obtain 33 potential CAs, and finally select a total of 8 CAs similar to PMCCL and PL Italy's business for CUP analysis
- Prepared a 42-page report analysing multinational business, intangible assets, and intra-group financing
- Analysed real estate and tax incentives for investment promotion in Changzhou and Wuxi, contacted the Bureau of Commerce and International Investment Centre to deliver advice on industrial layout of a labour-intensive foreign-owned enterprise in the Shanghai Metropolitan Area
- Consulted the State Administration of Foreign Exchange in Xiamen to apply accounting treatment regarding a consortium's internal transformation of capital flow by agreement
- Assisted the Suzhou Bureau of Economic and Trade Development in confirming and updating enterprise documents and suggested with tax planning to reduce operation costs and improve compliance

Audit Assistant (Internship) - Mazars (Industrial Park, Suzhou) 2021
Audit & Assurance, Annual Audit, Reporting & Accounting Operations Advisory Services

- Audited balance sheets and P&L statements of collective assets and state-owned enterprises in Xiangcheng District, tracked and matched the flow of funds and financial statements, produced 31 draft reports
- Verified state-owned assets of Kunshan Hi-Tech Group, independently conducted 7 audit working papers, calculated 9 financial details, reviewed 18 drafts and reported on large transactions

Consultant Assistant (Internship) - CITIC Securities (Kunshan, Suzhou)	2020
Wealth Management, Investment Consultation, Marketing	
Executive Assistant & Analyst Associate - Global Commerce (Suzhou)	2019 - 2022
Information & Consultation, Certification & Accreditation, FDI, International Trade Administration	
Research Assistant (Internship) - Bureau of Finance (Suzhou)	2019 - 2020
Treasury Management, Fiscal Policy, Government Budget, Financial Strategy	
Secretary Assistant (Internship) - Administration for Market Regulation (Suzhou)	2018
Quality Supervision, Intellectual Property, Food & Drug Administration, Anti-Monopoly	

PROGRAMMES, COMPETITIONS & CAMPUS EXPERIENCE

- Co-Investigator and Research Associate, National Social Science Fund of China Programme, Optimisation of Industrial Ecosystems for Advanced Manufacturing Clusters Based on Producer Services, *Oct 2022 - Present*
- Peer Advisor, Nanjing University Department of Finance & Insurance and Tsinghua University PBC School of Finance, Monetary Policy and Financial Stability, *Jun 2023 - June 2024*
- Peer Advisor, Provincial UG Innovative Training Programme, For Rural Revitalisation! Patterns, Dilemmas, and Prospects of Entrepreneurship in Less-Developed Areas, *May 2021 - Oct 2022*
- Investigator and Collaborator, National "Bringing Culture, Science & Health to the Countryside" Programme, How Industrial Organisations in Less-Developed Areas Capitalise on Local Historical Heritage? National Excellent Team Award, Jiangsu Provincial Special Excellent Team Award, NUFE Top Team Award, Best Report Award (1st Prize), *Jun 2021 - May 2022*
- Student Assistant, JESIE-UCLA-USJ Cooperation and Exchange Programme, International Business, Leadership, and Management, *Jan - Feb 2022*
- Investigator and Leader, National UG Innovative Training Programme, Silver-Hair Industry to Be Reshaped With New Retailing: A Story of China, *May 2020 - Oct 2021*
- Leader, Chinese Society for Optimisation, Overall Planning & Economic Mathematics Competition, "Mathorcup" MCM, S Award, *Apr - Jul 2021*
- Volunteer, NUFE Admissions Committee, *Dec 2019 - Jun 2021*
- Founder and Leader, China International "Internet Plus" Innovation & Entrepreneurship Competition, Reinventing Silver-Hair Industry with Models of New Retailing, *May 2020 - Apr 2021*
- Investigator and Leader, NUFE "Challenge Cup" Academic Competition for UG Students, Digital Economy, New Retailing, and Decent Work: Digital Retailing as a Promoter of Employment? *Nov 2020 - Mar 2021*
- Volunteer and Research Assistant, Jiangsu Administration for Market Regulation Programme, Customer Satisfaction Evaluation and Examination: Tertiary Sector in Jiangsu, *May - Nov 2020*

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Language Proficiency: Fluent in English and Mandarin with a good understanding of Wu